Employee Confidentiality Policy

Richtlinie zur Vertraulichkeit und zum Schutz von Geschäftsgeheimnissen

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Owner	Dr. Nadia Petrov, General Counsel and Data Protection Officer
Approved by	Dr. Katharina Weber, CEO (Geschäftsführerin)
Consulted	Priya Raman, CISO; Julia Neumann, HR Director; Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair (Betriebsrat)
Applies to	All persons who may have access to Norvane Systems confidential information at any site (Munich, Berlin, Garching, Frankfurt) or remotely
Classification	Internal
Language	English. A German version is available from HR on request.

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1 Purpose

This policy explains how we expect our employees to treat confidential information. Our employees will unavoidably receive and handle personal and private information about customers, partners and Norvane Systems itself. We want to make sure that this information is well protected.

We must protect this information for two reasons. It may:

- be legally protected (for example personal data under the GDPR/DSGVO and the BDSG, or sensitive customer data covered by contract);
- constitute the backbone of our business and give us a competitive advantage (for example business processes, source code and pricing). Such information may qualify as a trade secret under the German Trade Secrets Act (Geschäftsgeheimnisgesetz, GeschGehG), which requires us to take reasonable protective measures.

2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees, including the Managing Directors (Geschäftsführer), trainees, working students, interns, contractors, temporary agency staff and volunteers, as well as investors and advisers who may have access to confidential information. It applies on our premises, at home and while travelling.

3 What is confidential information

Confidential and proprietary information is secret, valuable, expensive and/or easily replicated. Employees may have various levels of authorized access to it. Common examples are:

Category	Examples at Norvane Systems
Unpublished financial information	Management accounts, forecasts and budgets in DATEV, unpublished annual figures.
Data of customers, partners and vendors	Customer contracts, network and infrastructure diagrams, access credentials, supplier terms.
Patents, formulas and new technologies	Source code, architecture designs, internal tooling, security findings and penetration test reports.
Customer lists	Existing and prospective customers, pipeline and opportunity data.
Data entrusted to us by external parties	Customer production data, data covered by an NDA.
Pricing, marketing and other undisclosed strategies	Price lists, tender offers, launch plans.
Documents and processes marked as confidential	Anything labelled "Confidential" or "Strictly confidential" (see section 4).
Unpublished goals, forecasts and initiatives marked as confidential	Strategic plans, planned acquisitions, organisational changes before announcement.
Personal data	HR files in Personio, payroll data, customer contact data. Handled in addition under NS-LEG-POL-001.

4 Classification levels

All documents and data are assigned one of four levels. The level is shown on the document (for example in the document-control table or the Microsoft 365 sensitivity label).

Level	Meaning	Who may receive it
Public	Approved for publication, for example website content and press releases.	Anyone
Internal	Default for internal documents and the company wiki. Disclosure would cause little harm.	All employees and contractors bound by confidentiality
Confidential	Customer data, contracts, finance, personal data, source code.	Named teams or roles, on a need-to-know basis
Strictly confidential	Information whose disclosure could seriously harm the company or a customer, for example M&A plans, security incident details, credentials.	Named individuals approved by the data owner

5 What you should do

- Lock or secure confidential information at all times. Lock your screen when you leave your desk and follow the clean-desk rule at the end of each working day.
- Shred confidential documents when they are no longer needed, using the lockable shredding containers (Datenschutztonnen) at each site. Do not use ordinary paper bins.
- Make sure you view confidential information only on secure devices: company laptops with disk encryption, or approved remote access. Do not view it in public places where others can read your screen.
- Disclose information to other employees only when it is necessary and authorized.
- Keep confidential documents inside our premises unless it is absolutely necessary to move them. If you must take paper documents out of the building, keep them with you and return them promptly.

6 What you must not do

- Use confidential information for any personal benefit or profit.
- Disclose confidential information to anyone outside of the company without authorization.
- Copy confidential documents and files and store them on insecure devices, private cloud storage, private email accounts or private messaging apps.

7 Confidentiality measures

We take measures to ensure that confidential information is well protected. We will:

Measure	How we do it	Responsible
Store and lock paper documents	Lockable cabinets and shredding containers at all sites.	Markus Vogel, Facilities Manager, ext. 6100

Encrypt electronic information and safeguard databases	Disk encryption, encrypted storage and transfer, role-based access. See NS-IT-POL-001.	Priya Raman, CISO, ext. 3100
Ask employees to sign non-disclosure agreements (NDAs)	Confidentiality obligations are part of every employment contract; separate NDAs are signed for specific customers and projects.	Julia Neumann, HR Director, ext. 2001
Require authorization before access to certain confidential information	Access to Confidential and Strictly confidential information is granted by the data owner (head of department) and requested through ServiceNow. Access is reviewed at least once a year.	Jonas Keller, IT Manager, ext. 3001

Post-employment non-compete obligations are agreed only in an individual written agreement that meets the legal requirements, including compensation. They are not part of this policy.

8 Exceptions and permitted disclosures

Confidential information may occasionally have to be disclosed for legitimate reasons. Examples are:

- if a regulatory body or authority requests it as part of an investigation or audit;
- if Norvane Systems examines a venture or partnership that requires disclosing some information (within legal boundaries and under an NDA).

In such cases, the employees involved must document their disclosure procedure and collect all needed authorizations before disclosing. We are bound to disclose no more information than needed.

Case	Authorization	Contact
Request from an authority, regulator or auditor	General Counsel. Forward the request without replying.	Dr. Nadia Petrov, ext. 2600
Partnership, investment or acquisition talks	NDA signed by Legal, and approval by a Managing Director or the CFO.	Stefan Hoffmann, CFO, ext. 1200
Disclosure to a customer or supplier	NDA or contract clause in place, and approval by the data owner.	Your line manager

Nothing in this policy prevents you from reporting suspected wrongdoing through our ethics hotline or an external reporting channel under the Whistleblower Protection Act (Hinweisgeberschutzgesetz, HinSchG), from speaking with the Works Council (Betriebsrat) about matters within its duties, or from exercising rights granted by law.

9 Reporting a breach

If you lose a device or document, send information to the wrong recipient, or suspect that confidential information has been disclosed, report it immediately to the IT helpdesk (helpdesk@norvane.example, ext. 3000) and to privacy@norvane.example (ext. 2600). Personal data breaches must be reported to the supervisory authority within 72 hours where required by the GDPR, so please do not wait until you are sure. Reporting promptly and in good faith will be taken into account when assessing the incident.

10 Leaving the company

When employees stop working for Norvane Systems, they are obliged to return any confidential files, documents and devices on or before their last working day and to delete confidential information from their personal devices and accounts. HR and IT confirm this in the exit checklist in Personio. Information that you hold in your head is not affected by this obligation, but you must not disclose trade secrets after you leave.

11 Consequences of a breach

Employees who do not respect this policy will face disciplinary and, possibly, legal action. We investigate every breach of this policy. Depending on the seriousness of the breach, consequences can range from a formal warning (Abmahnung) to termination of employment, with or without notice, in accordance with German employment law. The Works Council (Betriebsrat) is heard before any termination. Wilful breaches, and breaches committed for personal profit, are treated as particularly serious. We may also have to take action for unintentional breaches, depending on their frequency and seriousness, and repeated disregard of this policy, even if unintentional, can lead to termination.

This policy remains binding after your employment ends, to the extent permitted by law. Breaches may also result in claims for damages and criminal liability under the GeschGehG.

12 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
Policy owner, disclosures, ethics hotline	Dr. Nadia Petrov, General Counsel and DPO	ethics@norvane.example	2650
Data protection incidents	Data Protection Officer	privacy@norvane.example	2600
Security incidents, access rights	Priya Raman, CISO	priya.raman@norvane.example	3100
Lost devices, IT support	IT helpdesk	helpdesk@norvane.example	3000
Contracts, NDAs, exit checklist	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
Employee representation	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500

13 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-HR-POL-001	Employee Code of Conduct	General conduct, social media and conflicts of interest
NS-IT-POL-001	Information Security Policy	Technical protection measures, devices and access
NS-LEG-POL-001	Data Protection Policy	Personal data and data breaches

14 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	01.03.2023	Dr. Nadia Petrov	First issue.
1.1	10.11.2023	Dr. Nadia Petrov	Added exit checklist and reporting of breaches.
2.0	01.06.2026	Dr. Nadia Petrov	Revised after consultation with the Works Council; classification levels, authorization table and legal references added.

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